

Sex gets surreal in Luis Buñuel's *Belle de Jour*, while Hollywood **teases social taboos** in *The Graduate*, and smashes them wide open in *Bonnie and Clyde*.

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1967

New Hollywood hits the road with Peter Fonda and Dennis Hopper in *Easy Rider*, and Jon Voight and Dustin Hoffman in *Midnight Cowboy*.

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1969

Cinematic violence is taken to new extremes by *A Clockwork Orange*, *The French Connection*, and *Dirty Harry*.

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1971

Kung fu goes global, and Hong Kong actor Bruce Lee acquires cult status in *Enter the Dragon*.

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1973

1968



Space-age **science fiction** **thrills** audiences in *2001: Space Odyssey* and in the erotically charged *Barbarella*.

1970



MASH and *Catch-22* target the **insanity of war**, while *Le Boucher* explores the impulses that lead to murder.

1972



Francis Ford Coppola **redefines the gangster genre** with the first of *The Godfather* movies.

1974



Chinatown's **neo-noir** goes head to head with *The Godfather: Part II*, while Gene Hackman eavesdrops on *The Conversation*.

old orders. In Britain, another New Wave made hard-edged portraits of working-class life, such as *Saturday Night and Sunday Morning*. And a new, boldly unsqueamish attitude to screen violence took hold as the decade went on. Taking its cues from Godard and its story from the lives of two wild young outlaws in the Great Depression, Arthur Penn's *Bonnie and Clyde* set a benchmark of stylized bloodshed.

While the movies got on with what they had always done best—entertaining mass audiences—some filmmakers also tapped into the avant-garde and upended ideas of what a movie was. From the post-nuclear time-travel feature *La jetée* (*The Pier*, 1962), made up almost wholly of still photographs, to the teasing *Last Year At Marienbad*, (1961) or the split screen of Andy

Warhol's *Chelsea Girls* (1966), cinema was in the middle of a creative free-for-all. It was hardly surprising to find the ever-subversive Luis Buñuel at large in such an atmosphere, filming *The Discreet Charm of the Bourgeoisie* (1972) half a century after *Un Chien Andalou*.

New Hollywood

In response to the prospect of losing young audiences to television, the Hollywood that had once kept such a tight grip on its filmmakers now handed over a measure of control to a new breed of singular talents.

The results were American movies shot through with cynicism and irresolution. Some are best seen as historical documents, but others are enduring masterpieces. Francis Ford Coppola's *The Conversation* is a mystery of surveillance with a

dazzlingly intricate use of sound, while his saga of family and crime, *The Godfather*, is an all-time classic that still holds audiences in its grip. as does *The Godfather: Part II*, the prequel that follows Vito Corleone from the Old World to the New.

For an era that began with Truffaut and Godard gleefully riffing on Hollywood tropes, it was fitting to close with a relentless crisscross of influence between Europe and the US: visions of Boris Karloff amid the Spanish Civil War in *The Spirit of the Beehive*; the relocation of German-born Douglas Sirk's lush melodramas from Hollywood to 1970s Munich in Rainer Werner Fassbinder's *Ali: Fear Eats The Soul*; and *Chinatown*, a noir exposé of the black heart of southern California, directed by the Polish émigré Roman Polanski. ■